

# Collateralised Exposure Modelling: Bridging the Gap Risk \*

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## Abstract

Market-driven defaults, such as Archegos, pointed once more to the importance of Wrong Way Risk, concentration and leverage in shaping the tail of the credit loss distribution. In the following, Fabrizio Anfuso presents a minimal framework for the joint dynamics of the market risk factors, the trade and collateral portfolio and the overall balance sheet of the defaulting counterparty. Based on this framework, directly applied to the relevant example of an equity swap, the author draws general conclusions that can be used to improve the risk sensitivity of existing exposure metrics, especially in the presence of concentration, leverage and excess collateral.

## 1 Introduction

In the wake of the Archegos default [1], there has been consensus in listing the usual suspects (Wrong Way Risk (WWR), concentration and leverage) as the most dangerous triggers of gap risk (defined as the risk of sudden jumps in portfolio exposure) and, even more so, for supposedly over-collateralised portfolios.

In the present paper, we consider the structural WWR introduced for collateralised counterparties (CPTYs) by the very contractually agreed process of margining, where the daily rebalancing of the portfolio performance by means of exchanging variation and initial margins (VM and IM) may significantly affect the CPTY's exposure at default (EAD). Indeed, we show that CPTY exposure may be significant even in the presence of IM and discuss the potential implications for credit risk management, XVA and IMM.

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This is particularly relevant in the context of the Prime Brokerage business where, on the one hand, clients desire leverage and often run directional and concentrated portfolios but, on the other hand, brokers rely heavily on margins to risk-manage these portfolios.

The aim of our analysis is to understand under which conditions (of portfolio concentration, leverage and market correlations) margin-triggered defaults can cause a collateral shortfall materially beyond the magnitude estimated with the Basel Margin Period of Risk (MPOR) framework. To do so, we focus on the concrete example of an equity swap portfolio and we reconsider *ab initio* the calculation of the Counterparty Credit Risk (CCR) exposure in the presence of a collateral agreement; showing the insufficiency of the standard approaches to exposure measurement for concentrated and leveraged counterparties.

Our results are directly applicable to concentrated equity swaps portfolios and, at least on a qualitative level, to similarly leveraged and concentrated positions. In the following, we also outline how a solution based on pre-computed add-ons can be potentially used to account for collateral shortfalls in existing CCR exposure implementations.

From a technical perspective, two main ingredients are introduced: i) a “microscopic” model for the joint dynamics of the CPTY balance sheet and the portfolio underlying assets, ii) a stochastic process that allows for discontinuous moves in the portfolio underlying assets.

In a recent publication [2], Dickinson showed how Levy processes can be used to quantify the credit risk of leveraged exposures. Here, we rely on a similar set of tools to introduce a balance sheet model and describe coherently the interplay between: i) CPTY characteristics, such as Probability of Default (PD) and equity capital, ii) portfolio features, such as WWR, concentration and collateral and iii) market risk dynamics including jumps.

The remainder of the paper is organised as follows: the model is introduced in Sec.2; the key risk quantities and results for the most interesting limiting cases are shown in Secs.3 and 4; the consequences for collateralised and overcollateralised exposure metrics are outlined in Sec.5. Finally, conclusions are drawn in Sec.6.

## 2 The model

### 2.1 Description

Consider two CPTYs, A and B, entering a derivative contract, respectively short and long on a single equity position. In the following, our aim is to compute the loss distribution of the surviving CPTY A conditional upon B’s default.

To do so, we introduce a model that describes the correlated dynamics of: i) the A-B contract fair value and ii) B’s overall balance sheet (denoted

by  $\Theta$ ).

The A-B relation and the balance sheet can be characterised as follows:

1. The derivative tracks synthetically the equity performance. The A-B portfolio can be thought of as a total return swap (TRS) on a single underlying  $S$ , where the TRS is at-the-money (ATM) at  $t = 0$  and the interest rate leg is ignored. The maximum loss from B's perspective is equal to the starting value of the underlying  $S(0)$  multiplied by the notional of the contract. Throughout the paper, we absorb the contract notional in the definition of  $S$  and  $S(0)$ .
2. The contractual terms assumed are: i) daily bilateral VM to fully offset the current MtM of the trade; ii) unilateral (B posting only)  $IM = \alpha S^1$ .
3. The balance sheet size  $\Theta$  is shown in Fig.1, where the equity capital is referred to here as Net Asset Value (NAV). In our stylised model: i)  $\Theta$  is stochastic with constant liabilities  $L$ ; ii) the nominal PD<sup>2</sup> at the 1y horizon is considered as an input; iii) the  $\Theta$ 's probability distribution at the 1y horizon is known and depends on the starting value  $\Theta(0)$ , as well as on the calibration of the correspondent Stochastic Differential Equation (SDE) (see Eq.4).
4. *before entering the TRS*,  $L$  marks the threshold for  $\Theta$  that triggers the B's default. Therefore, we consider  $\Theta(0)$  as given and we compute the liabilities as  $L = \Phi_{(\Theta, 1y)}^{-1}(PD)$  (implicitly defining pre-TRS  $NAV(0) = \Theta(0) - L$ ).
5. *After entering the TRS*, the balance sheet includes VM and IM where, for convenience, posted collateral obligations are carved out from the NAV definition. And hence: i) VM tracks the performance of the TRS (i.e. it can be either posted collateral or part of the NAV); ii) IM is always part of the posted collateral until contract maturity (although in varying amount); iii) the default time of B is now identified as the first  $t > 0$  such that  $NAV(t) < 0$ , i.e. B is unable to meet its pre-existing liabilities or a new margin call.
6. In our notation,  $S(0)$  is expressed as a fraction of the  $t = 0$  NAV (pre-TRS) via the constant  $K_{NAV}$ , so as to highlight the *implicit leverage*

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<sup>1</sup> $\alpha$  is a constant. It can be set (see our example in Fig.3) as a tail quantile of the  $S$  model distribution at the MPOR horizon, i.e.  $\alpha = 1 - \frac{\Phi_{(S, 2w)}^{-1}(q=0.01)}{S(0)}$ . The *explicit* leverage of the position is defined as  $1/\alpha = S(0)/IM$ .

<sup>2</sup>Throughout the paper, we always refer to the nominal PD, i.e. the probability of default as assessed *before* entering the TRS trade. In practice, for the extreme leveraged cases, the actual PD may differ significantly from the nominal one (with no implications for our findings).

of the position<sup>3</sup>.  $K_{\text{NAV}}$  gives an account of the additional risk (in proportional terms) that comes for B from the TRS portfolio. And it provides an indicative measure of how much a drop in the value of  $S$  is likely to affect the PD of B.

Based on the above, the joint dynamics of  $S$  and  $\Theta$  is described by the following system of SDEs:

$$\begin{aligned} dS(t) &= \tilde{\mu}_S S(t)dt + \sigma_S S(t)dW_S(t) + \beta_S S(t)dJ_S(t), \\ S(0) &= K_{\text{NAV}} \cdot \text{NAV}(0) \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

$$\Delta_{mf}(C_{\text{VM}}(t)) = -\Delta_{mf}(S(t)), \quad C_{\text{VM}}(0) = 0 \quad (2)$$

$$\Delta_{mf}(C_{\text{IM}}(t)) = \alpha \Delta_{mf}(S(t)), \quad C_{\text{IM}}(0) = \alpha S(0) \quad (3)$$

$$\begin{aligned} d\Theta(t) &= \tilde{\mu}_\Theta \Theta(t)dt + \sigma_\Theta \Theta(t)dW_\Theta(t) + \beta_\Theta(1 - \beta_S \rho_J) \Theta(t)dJ_\Theta(t) + \\ &\quad \beta_S \rho_J \Theta(t)dJ_S(t) \end{aligned} \quad (4)$$

$$\begin{aligned} d\text{NAV}(t) &= d\Theta(t) + (1 - \alpha)\Delta_{mf}(S(t)), \\ \text{NAV}(0) &= \Theta(0) - L - \alpha S(0). \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

Where:

- (i) The  $S$  and  $\Theta$  dynamics are described on an individual basis by the Merton Jump-Diffusion model.
- (ii)  $W_S$  and  $W_\Theta$  are the continuous Brownian components of the  $S$  and  $\Theta$  geometric dynamics. Their instantaneous correlation is given by  $dW_S(t)dW_\Theta(t) = \rho_W dt$ .
- (iii)  $J_S$  and  $J_\Theta$  (with intensities  $\lambda_S$  and  $\lambda_\Theta$  and normally-distributed jumps  $\phi(\mu_{j_S}, \sigma_{j_S})$  and  $\phi(\mu_{j_\Theta}, \sigma_{j_\Theta})$ ) are compound Poisson processes providing the discontinuous “gap risk” components of the  $S$  and  $\Theta$  dynamics.
- (iv) The drifts  $\tilde{\mu}_\Theta = \mu_\Theta - (\beta_\Theta(1 - \beta_S \rho_J)\lambda_\Theta \mu_{j_\Theta} + \beta_S \rho_J \lambda_S \mu_{j_S})$  and  $\tilde{\mu}_S = \mu_S - \beta_S \lambda_S \mu_{j_S}$  include the compensation for the jump processes.
- (v)  $C_{\text{VM}}(t)$  and  $C_{\text{IM}}(t)$  indicate the collateral balances from the non-defaulting A’s perspective.
- (vi)  $mf$  is the contractual margining frequency (1d in the following) and  $\Delta_{mf}()$  indicates the accrued change over the period  $mf$  based on end of day (EOD) market quotes. In our case,  $\Delta_{1d}C_{\text{VM}}(t) = -\Delta_{1d}(S(t)) = (-S(t) + S(t - 1d))$ , being  $S(t)$  and  $S(t - 1d)$  EOD quotes as of  $t$  and as of the day before.

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<sup>3</sup>Since the notional of the contract is absorbed in the definition of  $S$  and the starting value of the underlying is given, we *de facto* tune the notional so as to match the desired level of implicit leverage.

- (vii)  $\beta_S$  and  $\beta_\Theta$  are binary variables, that will be used (see Sec.4) to realise different risk configurations.
- (viii) Finally,  $\rho_J$  measures how much  $\Theta$  is *directly* affected by a sudden variation in value of  $S$ , accounting for any exposure (other than the A-B portfolio) to the same or to strongly correlated underlyings.

## 2.2 The model calibration and its scope of applicability

Despite its simplicity, the model defined in Eqns.1-5 already has a large number of parameters (16! To account for  $[\text{PD}, \alpha, \Theta(0), \mu_\Theta, \sigma_\Theta, \lambda_\Theta, \mu_{j_\Theta}, \sigma_{j_\Theta}, K_{\text{NAV}}, \mu_S, \sigma_S, \lambda_S, \mu_{j_S}, \sigma_{j_S}, \rho_W, \rho_J]$ ). We shall introduce the following assumptions to reduce the dimensionality:

- (a)  $\mu_S = \mu_B = 0$ , since any reasonable drift will not affect extreme loss scenarios over a 1y horizon<sup>4</sup>.
- (b)  $\sigma_S = \sigma_\Theta = \sigma_W$ , i.e. we assume some risk homogeneity across the assets of counterparty B, at least when it comes to the diffusive components.
- (c)  $\sigma_{j_S} = \sigma_{j_\Theta} = 0$ , i.e. we focus on constant jumps, so as to keep a simple distinction between the continuous and discontinuous stochastic components.
- (d)  $\mu_{j_S} = \mu_{j_\Theta} = \mu_J < 0$ , i.e. we introduce the same risk homogeneity assumption made for (a) above.
- (e) For the jump parameters  $[\lambda_J, \mu_J]$ , we consider two example calibrations: Near Death Jumps (NDJ) (-50%, in average once in 10y) and Jump-to-Default (JTD) (-99%, in average once in 100y) where the former stylises a large equity down move not leading to the default of the issuer (whereas the latter does and occurs with a likelihood commensurate with the PD of the issuer)<sup>5</sup>.

Finally, our analysis for the single equity swap case (see Sec.4) leverages on the simplicity of the portfolio and on the analytical properties of the model introduced. Nevertheless, in the presence of additional trades, e.g. for multiple equity swaps also in a long-short combination, we can still use this approach to gauge the collateral shortfall (as defined in Sec.3). From a calibration perspective, this will require us to:

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<sup>4</sup>As a consequence of this choice, both  $S$  and  $\Theta$  are martingales, providing us with  $S(0)$  as a natural unit, since  $\mathbb{E}[S(t)] = S(0)$ .

<sup>5</sup>To perform a first principles calibration of  $[\lambda_J, \mu_J]$ , one can consider the frequency of occurrences of equity down moves that qualifies as jumps for a large dataset of equity time-series. Historically observed jumps can be further bucketed e.g. based on additional dimensions such as country, sector and rating.

- (i) Identify the most material concentration in the portfolio, considering clusters of correlated assets (e.g. from the same sector and/or country)<sup>6</sup>, and assign to it a suitable calibration; where the jump size should be approximately scaled down by the relative weight of the overall position.
- (ii) Estimate  $\rho_J$  as an approximate measure of the correlation between the identified concentrated position(s) and the assets side of the balance sheet at  $t = 0$ .

### 3 VM driven defaults and collateral shortfall

In the standard MPOR framework, the default time is defined as the first time  $t_d$  when the defaulting counterparty is unable to meet its contractual obligations. And the MPOR horizon is chosen so as to account, in the exposure at closeout  $t_c = t_d + \text{MPOR}$ , for the risks related to the trades replacement and collateral liquidation. In practice, this means that the collateralised exposure is computed for a (given) default time as:

$$EE(t_d) = \mathbb{E}[\max\{MtM(t_c) - C(t_d^+) + \cancel{C(t_d^+)} - \cancel{C(t_d^-)}, 0\}] \quad (6)$$

where: i) for simplicity, we consider only collateral posted in the settlement currency (i.e. carrying no risk over the MPOR); ii) the cancelled term is ignored.

As discussed more extensively in Sec.5, the standard approach implicitly assumes that the contractual obligations at  $t_d^-$  and  $t_d^+$  are *de facto* equivalent, i.e. the collateral shortfall and the exposure, if measured in the limit  $\text{MPOR} \rightarrow 0$ , are generally vanishingly small.

Here, we perform a comprehensive simulation, inclusive of the B credit default event, where the time of default is identified by the first breach of the *going concern* condition  $\text{NAV}(t) \geq 0$ . As we will see, the collateral shortfall conditional upon default (the cancelled term in Eqn.6) is generally different from 0.

Focussing on VM-only contractual relations first, we define the VM shortfall as the following expectation:

$$\text{SF}_{\text{VM}} = \mathbb{E}[\max\{-\Delta_{1d}(S(t^*)), 0\} | \mathcal{D} \neq \emptyset], \quad \mathcal{D} = \{t_n \leq 1y | \text{NAV}(t_n) < 0\}, \quad (7)$$

where  $t^* = \inf(\mathcal{D})$  indicates the first (if any) time on a path when, post (hypothetically) accounting for the margining obligations, the *going concern* condition is breached.

For the computation of  $\text{SF}_{\text{VM}}$ , we can rely on the model introduced in Eqns.1-5 to simulate the  $S$  and  $\Theta$  dynamics and detect defaults up to 1y

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<sup>6</sup>In the case of Archegos, the long positions on tech shares would have defined one of such clusters.

horizon.  $SF_{VM}$  is then obtained as an average of the observed shortfalls (including scenarios where the default is unrelated to the margining process and for which shortfalls are zero).

In the presence of IM, a general definition of the collateral shortfall is less straightforward, primarily because the IM is often held by a third-party custodian (as opposed to VM that is generally held by the CPTY); and the daily margining process for IM, especially in the case of large VM moves, may depend upon the specifics of the contract. In the following, we assume that the larger of  $IM(t^*)$  and  $IM(t^* - 1d)$  is available to the non defaulting CPTY to offset the  $SF_{VM}$ , i.e. the overall collateral shortfall in the presence of IM becomes:

$$SF_C = \mathbb{E}[\max\{-\Delta_{1d}(S(t^*)) - \max\{IM(t^*), IM(t^* - 1d)\}, 0\} | \mathcal{D} \neq \emptyset],$$

$$\mathcal{D} = \{t_n \leq 1y | NAV(t_n) < 0\}. \quad (8)$$

(E.g., for the A-B equity swap portfolio, a default event with a material  $SF_C$  is driven by a large missed VM margin call partially offset by  $IM=IM(t^* - 1d)$ ).

Finally, it is worth emphasising that  $SF_C$  materialises before the unwinding of the position and the liquidation of the collateral. Therefore any additional exposure built up over the MPOR, e.g. driven by liquidity and/or market distress, will contribute to the loss (these components, i.e. the non cancelled terms in Eqn.6, are ignored in the following, where we focus on  $SF_C$ ).

In the next section, we characterise  $SF_C$  for the equity swap portfolio as a function of the model parameters; focussing on cuts of the calibration space where gap risk, concentration and leverage affect materially the resulting exposures.

## 4 Expected collateral shortfall for the equity swap portfolio

In our analysis, we consider the following limiting cases (refer also to Tab.1 for the details of the inputs):

- L1/L2: Continuous  $\Theta$  and  $S$  (VM only):** Continuous  $\Theta$  and  $S$  is the baseline case (**L1**) where we confirm that the  $SF_{VM}$  is negligible, consistently with the Basel III MPOR framework. Adding  $\Theta$  jumps only (**L2**) has hardly any impact. Both for **L1** and **L2**, the  $SF_{VM}$  is of the order of the daily diffusion volatility ( $\approx 0.4\sqrt{\frac{\sigma_W}{365}} \approx 0.006$ ).
- L3: continuous  $\Theta$  and discontinuous  $S$  (VM only):** See left panel of Fig.2. The presence of  $S$  jumps significantly increases the materiality of  $SF_{VM}$  w.r.t. **L1** and **L2**. Key remarks:

- (i) As a function of the implicit leverage  $K_{NAV}$ ,  $SF_{VM}$  can quickly reach the level of the IM and beyond.
- (ii) The shortfall curves are inversely proportional to  $\rho_W$ . In practice, the  $S/\Theta$  WWR dynamics can push the trade's  $MtM$  and A's posting requirements up, while depleting B's balance sheet size; and a large shortfall scenario may occur when, after an upside trend for  $S$ , a jump event triggers a margin call that cannot be met.
- (iii) The level of the PD does not change the qualitative behaviour but has an impact on the size of  $SF_{VM}$ . For lower PDs, the marginal weight of jump-driven defaults is larger.

**L4: Discontinuous  $\Theta$  and  $S$  processes (VM only):** See central and right panels of Fig.2. A positive  $\rho_J$  component of  $S$  jumps in the  $\Theta$  SDE can generate substantial shortfalls also at moderate levels of  $K_{NAV}$ . Key remarks:

- (i)  $\rho_J$  depletes  $\Theta$  whenever  $S$  experiences a (negative) jump and hence, *de facto*, increases the implicit leverage. Something quite similar to this mechanism (that does not need to be perfectly synchronous as stylised here) played a major role in the Archegos default<sup>7</sup>.
- (ii) As for **L3**,  $SF_{VM}$  can quickly reach the level of the IM (or even multiples of), in this case also for significantly lower levels of  $K_{NAV}$ .
- (iii) For the **L4** example, the diffusion correlation  $\rho_W$  (aligned with  $\rho_J$ ) is RWR only. WWR among the continuous Brownian drivers enhances the level of the shortfalls even further. However this does not seem to be a commonly realised set-up.
- (iv) For large  $\rho_J$ , crossings may occur between  $SF_{VM}$  curves with different values for  $K_{NAV}$  (see e.g. curves  $K_{NAV} = 0.4$  and  $K_{NAV} = 0.5$  at  $\rho_J \approx 0.4$ ). This effect is driven by the increasing likelihood of continuous defaults for higher implicit leverages; where the jumps are instrumental in bringing  $\Theta$  closer to the default line, but the actual default is triggered by a smooth random change.

**L5/L6: Including IM:** See left and central panels of Fig.3. The presence of excess collateral (of the order of SIMM IM [3]) does reduce the impact of the implicit leverage on  $SF_C$  both for the  $S$  jumps only (**L5**, left panel) and for the  $S$  &  $\Theta$  jumps (**L6**, right panel) cases.

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<sup>7</sup>Here we refer to the domino of tech shares down moves that was initiated by the major drop in value of Viacom ( $\approx -54\%$ ).



This reduction is mostly driven by the increased likelihood of continuous defaults, since the IM practically counts as an additional liability. If the default is not smooth,  $SF_C$  is not much affected by the excess collateral primarily because of the simplicity of the model considered, where jumps can have only one size (both for JTD and NDJ,  $\mu_J \gg \alpha$ ). Using a more realistic jump dynamics would allow us to resolve better the loss-absorbing effect on the IM for discontinuous defaults also.

| Cases     | PD     | $\alpha$ | $\beta_S$ | $\beta_\Theta$ | $\Theta(0)$ | $\sigma_W$ | $\lambda_J, \mu_J$ | $K_{NAV}$ | $\rho_W$ | $\rho_J$ |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|----------------|-------------|------------|--------------------|-----------|----------|----------|
| <b>L1</b> | $x$    | 0        | 0         | 0              | 10          | 0.3        | 0                  | $x$       | $x$      | 0        |
| <b>L2</b> | $x$    | 0        | 0         | 1              | 10          | 0.3        | JTD                | $x$       | $x$      | 0        |
| <b>L3</b> | $x$    | 0        | 1         | 0              | 10          | 0.3        | JTD                | $x$       | $x$      | 0        |
| <b>L4</b> | $x$    | 0        | 1         | 0              | 10          | 0.3        | $x$                | $x$       | $\rho_J$ | $x$      |
| <b>L5</b> | 100bps | $x$      | 1         | 0              | 10          | 0.3        | JTD                | $x$       | $x$      | 0        |
| <b>L6</b> | 100bps | $x$      | 1         | 0              | 10          | 0.3        | JTD                | $x$       | $\rho_J$ | $x$      |

Table 1: The model calibrations used for the different limiting cases **L1-L6** are shown. Notice the following: i) entry  $x$  indicates that multiple values are considered for the given parameter; ii) another parameter as entry (e.g. **L4**,  $\rho_W$ ) indicates that multiple values are considered in sync with the entry parameter ( $\rho_J$ ).

## 5 Making EADs and PFEs non-zero...

In Sec.4, we have shown how collateral shortfalls can be comparable to or even larger than the typical IM. This is directly relevant for the EAD and Potential Future Exposure (PFE) of e.g. funds and hedge funds portfolios [4]; and more generally for all those counterparties with high levels of concentration and implicit leverage<sup>8</sup>.

As shown in the right panel of Fig.3, the direct application of the standard path-wise collateral modelling used in IMM and XVA[5] produces EADs  $\approx 0$  whenever an IM of the order of SIMM[3] is present; i.e. deeming *de facto* the portfolio riskless both from a CCR Pillar 1 and risk monitoring perspectives.

This is not surprising, since the industry standard approach does not contemplate any shortfall at default; and the portfolio exposure is built up by random increments over the MPOR generated by Risk Factors Evolution (RFE) models that are typically continuous and do not account for WWR endogenously<sup>9</sup>. Since the simulated exposures will exceed the VM+IM only

<sup>8</sup>Archegos is an obvious example, with up to 85% of the NAV tied up as collateral and the quasi-totality of the assets invested long in a group of highly correlated tech shares.

<sup>9</sup>In [6] and [7], the authors suggest material improvements to this oversimplified picture,

for a tiny amount of scenarios, the final EAD and PFE result often close to 0.

Converting established modelling frameworks to support discontinuous dynamics *ab initio* presents major challenges, including the additional model risk of the enhanced calibration. Nevertheless, an alternative approach worth considering is to modify the standard collateral modelling so as to account for collateral shortfalls exogenously. For example, introducing a framework along the following lines:

- (i) Identify the main portfolio concentrations (see also Sec. 2.2) and their risk profiles. This can be done in multiple ways, either statically (based on the  $t=0$  portfolio) or dynamically (at scenario level, in simulation). The former approach can be readily implemented (e.g. relying on SA-CCR[9] hedging sets' PFEs). The latter offers the possibility of detecting scenario-dependent concentrations.
- (ii) Assess the counterparty implicit leverage  $K_{NAV}$ <sup>10</sup>, referring to the main portfolio concentrations and e.g. based on stress testing of the  $t = 0$  portfolio and information such as the NAV.
- (iii) Gauge the level of the correlations  $\rho_J$  and  $\rho_W$  (see also Sec. 2.2) between the concentrated portfolio underlyings and the counterparty assets.
- (iv) Include  $SF_{VM}$  add-ons in the exposure calculation (this can be a static or a dynamic amount depending on how concentration is measured). Those add-ons can be pre-computed for a broad range of risk factors, pay-offs and calibrations; and associated to the portfolio (or portfolio scenarios) based on leverage, concentration and correlations.

In general, we do expect that, for concentrated and leveraged positions,  $SF_{VM}$  should offset a large part of the IM, therefore restoring EAD and PFE as non-zero measures of risk. Notice, in this regard, that accounting for VM shortfalls is the primary reason to introduce IM anyway. **Hence, not considering the effect of gap moves and potential collateral shortfalls at default in the exposure calculation, at least for concentrated portfolios, is tantamount to double-counting collateral.**

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but still primarily relying on continuous RFEs. Some practical extensions to discontinuous RFEs have been considered in [8].

<sup>10</sup>Sourcing  $K_{NAV}$  can be challenging for some CPTYs. Nevertheless, a framework to estimate this (or a similar) quantity, either accurately or conservatively, should be an integral part of the due diligence process (given its determining impact on the risk of the transaction).

## 6 Conclusions

We introduced a model for the joint dynamics of the defaulting CPTY balance sheet and of the underlying assets in the portfolio. Based on this, we showed how the interplay of concentration, leverage and correlations may materially affect the exposure of a collateralised equity swap portfolio. And we provided a detailed account of the different emerging risk profiles as a function of the key portfolio's and CPTY's characteristics. Finally, we outlined how, at least conceptually, our findings can be tailored to adjust existing CCR EAD and PFE metrics via a framework based upon pre-computed add-ons.

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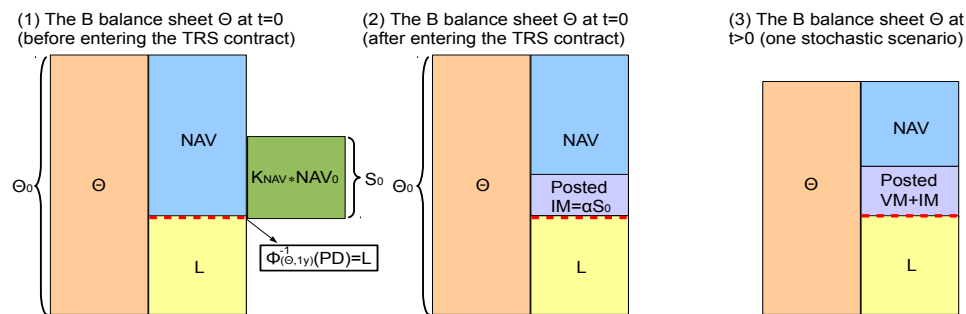


Figure 1: The B's balance sheet as described in Sec.2.1. The three panels show respectively: (1)  $t = 0$ , pre-TRS contract; (2)  $t = 0$ , post TRS (ATM) contract; (3)  $t > 0$ , one possible stochastic scenario where the balance sheet size  $\Theta$  and the NAV are reducing while the posted collateral amount is increasing ( $S(t) < S(0)$ ).

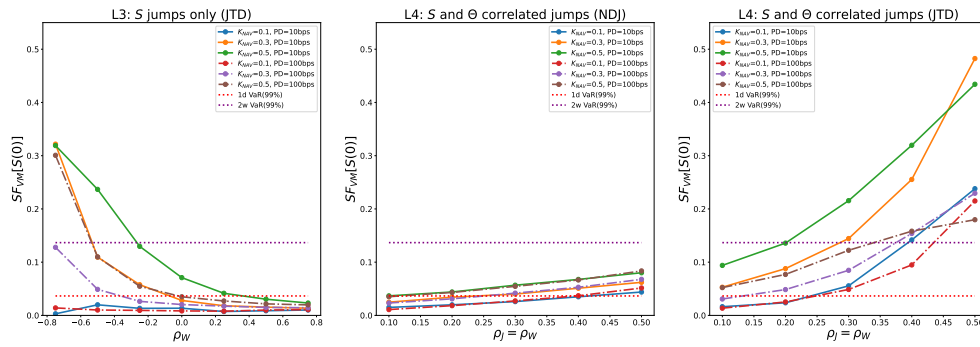


Figure 2: **Left panel (L3)**:  $SF_{VM}$  in the presence of  $S$  jumps only is shown as a function of  $\rho_W$  for jump calibration JTD and different levels of the PD and  $K_{NAV}$ . **Central and right panels (L4)**:  $SF_{VM}$  in the presence of correlated  $S$  and  $\Theta$  jumps is shown as a function of the jump correlation  $\rho_J$  ( $\rho_W = \rho_J$ ) for different levels of the PD,  $K_{NAV}$  and jump calibrations (central panel: NDJ, right panel: JTD). **All panels**:  $SF_{VM}$  is expressed in units of  $S(0)$  and the 99th percentile Value at Risk (VaR(99%)) values for the TRS trade over 1d and 2w horizons are shown for comparison (in units of  $S(0)$  as well). Note that the IM is often computed as a VaR(99%) metric of the MtM distribution over a 2w horizon.

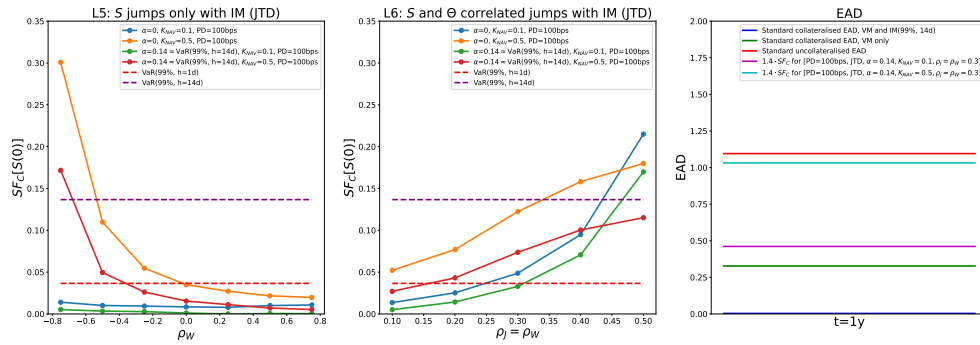


Figure 3: **Left and central panels:** the impact of the IM on the collateral shortfall is shown ( $\alpha \approx 0.14$ , corresponding to  $\text{IM}=\text{VaR}(99\%, 2w)$ ).  $SF_C$  is expressed in units of  $S(0)$  and  $\text{VaR}(99\%)$  values over 1d and 2w horizons are shown for comparison (in units of  $S(0)$  as well). **Left panel (L5):**  $SF_C$  in the presence of  $S$  jumps only is shown as a function of  $\rho_W$  for  $\text{PD}=100\text{bps}$  and jump calibration JTD. **Central panel (L6):**  $SF_C$  in the presence of correlated  $S$  and  $\Theta$  jumps is shown as a function of the jump correlation  $\rho_J$  ( $\rho_W = \rho_J$ ) for  $\text{PD}=100\text{bps}$  and jump calibration JTD. **Right panel:** EAD for a TRS trade (ATM,  $S(0) = 10$ ). Five cases are considered (from the bottom): i) standard collateralised EAD in the presence of  $\text{IM}=\text{VaR}(99\%, 2w)$ ; ii) standard collateralised EAD, VM only; iii)  $1.4 \cdot SF_C$  in the presence of  $\text{IM}=\text{VaR}(99\%, 2w)$ , computed for  $[\text{PD}=100\text{bps}, \text{JTD}, \alpha = 0.14, K_{\text{NAV}} = 0.1, \rho_j = \rho_W = 0.3]$ , where the 1.4 factor is the so-called alpha multiplier as defined in Basel II [10]; iv)  $1.4 \cdot SF_C$  in the presence of  $\text{IM}=\text{VaR}(99\%, 2w)$ , computed for  $[\text{PD}=100\text{bps}, \text{JTD}, \alpha = 0.14, K_{\text{NAV}} = 0.5, \rho_j = \rho_W = 0.3]$ ; v) standard uncollateralised EAD.